

My Education Teaching Philosophy

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My teaching philosophy is rooted in my belief on how students are not solely learners but are also facilitators in the classroom. Facilitation in the classroom means various things such as leading warm ups, peer feedback, opportunities to take initiative and have creative control over the art and work they produce. Students have diverse ways of learning and producing their work and it is important for students to have creative control and find their artistic style while also exploring various styles. As an educator I always believe that students are leaders and should advocate for themselves and their peers. Students are also humans and aren't just students, they have needs that need to be met and I believe that students have the right to speak up for themselves and their education. While I am responsible for what my students learn and how they learn, students are also responsible for providing me feedback on what they believe needs to change to better their learning. I, as an educator, grow alongside my students and learn from them. Students bring a wide range of needs, strengths, and lived experiences into their learning environment. Recognizing this diversity in my classroom is essential in supporting their growth. Some students may require differentiated instruction and various pedagogical learning styles, while other students may require more structure. Beyond students' academic abilities, students and their social emotional development play a role in my students' success in the classroom. It is crucial to create a classroom environment where students feel safe, respected, and included.

As an educator, my role in the classroom is to teach and lead students to find their skills and passions. I also have the responsibility to foster and create a classroom that engages and welcomes students from all diverse backgrounds where students feel encouraged and supported. I also hold the responsibility to provide students with accurate information and to also be honest

with them if I don't know the answer to a question they may have. My personal learning philosophy is that learning is ongoing and does not stop once I leave the classroom and graduate. I learn and am shaped by personal experiences and through my students. I also believe that education is collaborative where teachers learn through curiosity and reflection. I don't expect my students to know everything and it is important that I remind them that I also don't know everything and that I learn with them as well. I have expectations in the classroom where students must be respectful, kind, risk-takers, and transparent and I must also model these behaviors for students. I also believe in creative control over learning and art. This guides my approach as a teacher by allowing students to present personal projects in various ways, and encouraging new strategies they want to implement in their projects or in the classroom. I also believe in advocacy and change for improvement in all aspects. This is shown in my teaching practices by allowing students to give me feedback whether it be through anonymous google forms, class discussions, and creating class expectations as a group and not just me.

My philosophy is reflected in my abilities as an educator. I recognize that I have various strengths such as supporting students and their learning in various ways through pedagogical styles, positive reinforcement, constant encouragement through conversations, and allowing them to have creative control. I also recognize that my strengths as an educator are assessing progress fairly through assessments and providing feedback for students that helps them improve rather than it being just an evaluation.

Education to me as an educator is the process of helping individuals develop fundamental skills, knowledge, and habits that further their growth as humans. It is not simply the collection of information, but rather the ability to apply that knowledge to develop critical thinking, problem solving, and meaningful interactions. Fostering a love for learning is indispensable

when working with students in the classroom. When an educator is passionate, eager, content with what they are teaching, students learn to be curious, and have the drive to learn and engage in the material. Fostering love turns obligation to intrinsic motivation that encourages risk taking and exploration.

My want to be a theater teacher wasn't random but rather through a series of life experiences. Growing up I always needed support from educators through conversations and frequent encouragement. I had built healthy and positive relationships that helped me as an individual when there were moments of struggle. I know I am not the only child to have needed support. I have always been very thankful about the support I received because I was able to be successful with the encouragement I needed. When I first entered high school, I had joined the drama club and began performing. My love for performing and creating a world separate from mine was very fascinating for me and allowed me to be creative and find my passion. I enjoyed working with the ensemble, creating memories, and learning about storytelling in a non traditional way. My love for learning adds to my love for care, performance and nurturing in the classroom. I went from playing school with my sister in our room at home, to being in the classroom and teaching as an adult. My theater teacher journey was shaped through the relationships that supported me into who I am now and how I want to foster that same care and success for future generations.